correct as a matter of law. The fact that Justice Forde went on to accept nevertheless that 'Bhagat Singh is a sincere revolutionary' after hearing his arguments in his defence only goes to show that deep down he knew that Bhagat Singh was on to something.

On 15 June 1929, both Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were taken to their respective jails. Bhagat Singh was whisked off to Mianwali Jail. B.K. Dutt was sent to Lahore Jail. On the way, the two of them had an opportunity to sit together in the train carriage. This is when they decided that, if the state continued to refuse to treat them as political prisoners, they would go on hunger strike. They had ample reason to feel so aggrieved. Though they ended up in jail, neither Bhagat Singh nor B.K. Dutt, however, were subject to transportation. But this was not because the high court subsequently decided to show them leniency. It was because both were now linked to the Lahore Conspiracy Case. There was to be a new trial, one that would lead to Bhagat Singh's execution. This was the second of the three trials which Bhagat Singh had to face. This second trial began in the sessions court on 10 July 1929 before Judge Rai Sahib Pandit Sri Kishen, an Indian judge.

The trial of the Delhi Assembly Bomb Case had been long, excruciating and painfully drawn-out. The unforgiving glare of media publicity monitored and attested to everything that happened in the courtroom. By the end, Bhagat Singh, ever a consummate believer in the justness of his cause, had turned public opinion in his favour. In the process, however, and indeed soon after his arrest, he had also been linked to the Saunders murder. This was unsurprising. Bhagat Singh had left signed copies, in his own handwriting, splattered across the city of Lahore, making it easy for the authorities to link him to the murder. By 16 April 1929 most of the core members of the HSRA had been arrested and sent to trial. What followed in the Lahore Conspiracy Case drew the public's sympathy in his favour because, as Maclean states, 'Bhagat Singh conducted the court case with considerable *nous,* inviting extraordinary suffering, undertaking several hunger strikes and withstanding police abuse in the courtroom. In the 23 months it took for the imperial justice system to take him to the gallows, Bhagat Singh became a household name.'[7] At the height of his ordeal at the